

768–814 CE During the reign of Charlemagne, the country is established as a buffer state against Spanish Muslims.

1278 The Bishop of the Spanish diocese of Urgel and the Count of Foix are designated co-princes of Andorra. The rights vested in the house of Foix pass by marriage to the Kings of Navarre and, in 1589 on the accession of Henri of Navarre as Henri IV, to the crown of France.

1814 Independence confirmed.

1933–34 French occupation after the proclamation of independent King Boris I.

1982 First General Council or parliament is appointed.

1991 EU customs union comes into effect.

1993 Andorra joins the UN.

1994 Government falls; replaced by center-right Liberal cabinet.

2002 Andorra adopts the euro.

2009 Andorra agrees to ease banking secrecy rules.

Portugal



An Atlantic-facing country with natural borders and a long maritime and imperial history.

100s BCE Portugal is conquered by Roman forces, becoming the provinces of Lusitania and Gallaecia. When the empire falls, Portugal is conquered by the Visigoths and the Sueves after 409 CE.

711 The Moors arrive on the Iberian peninsula; the south of Portugal becomes Muslim; the north remains Christian.

1139 Afonso Henriques declares himself king of Portugal, formerly a county of the Spanish kingdom of León and Castile.

1147 Lisbon falls to Christian forces.

1254 First parliament convened at Leiria.

1272 Afonso III expels the last of the Moors from the Algarve.

1290 First university founded in Lisbon.

1369–85 Castilian rule is reestablished, but is ended at the Battle of Aljubarrota (1385) where English archers are crucial.

1387 Anglo-Portuguese alliance is cemented by marriage of King João I to an English princess.

1415 Portugal founds the first modern European colony in Africa at Ceuta.

1418 Prince Henry the Navigator, son of João I, sponsors a series of voyages of exploration into the Atlantic and south along the coast of Africa.

1419 Portugal takes Madeira, followed by the Azores in 1427, Cape Verde Islands in 1456, Guinea in 1480, and São Tomé and Príncipe islands in 1483.

1445 A slave market and fort are established by the Portuguese in Arguin Bay in present-day Mauritania.

1470s Lisbon becomes a major slave port. By 1539 over 12,000 slaves are being sold in the city's markets each year.

1494 Under the Treaty of Tordesillas, Pope Alexander VI divides the "New World" recently discovered by Columbus between Portugal and Spain.

1497–99 Vasco da Gama voyages around the Cape of Good Hope to India.

1500 Pedro Álvares Cabral accidentally discovers Brazil on journey to India; Brazil soon develops into a large colony.

1510 Portuguese establish a colony at Goa in India and Macao in China in 1557. Territories are also acquired in Angola and Mozambique and the east Indies.

1578 King Sebastião is killed at the Battle of Alcazarquivir in Morocco. He is succeeded by his brother Henrique.

1580 Philip II of Spain claims the Portuguese crown on the death of Henrique and invades.

1580–1640 Portugal united with Spain.

1598–1663 Many overseas territorial possessions lost to the Dutch.

1640 Portugal regains its independence from Spain after an uprising led by the Duke of Braganza, crowned João IV.

1755 Earthquake destroys Lisbon.

1793 Joins coalition against revolutionary France.

1807 France invades; royal family flees to Brazil.

1808 British troops arrive under Wellington: start of the Peninsular War, which lasts until 1812.

1820 Uprisings in Porto and Lisbon. Liberal revolution.

1821 King João VI returns from exile in Brazil and accepts the first Portuguese constitution. In 1822 his son and regent, Dom Pedro, declares independence as Emperor Pedro I of Brazil.

1834 Dom Pedro returns to Portugal to end civil war and installs his daughter as Queen Maria II.

1890 Planned land connection between Portuguese colonies of Angola and Mozambique thwarted by the British.

1908 Assassination of Carlos I and the heir to the throne.

1910 Abdication of Manuel II and proclamation of the republic.

1916 Portugal fights with the Allies in World War I.

1926 Army overturns republic.

1928 António Salazar joins government as finance minister.

1932 Salazar becomes prime minister.

1933 Constitution of the "New State," instituting right-wing dictatorship.

1936–39 Salazar assists Franco in Spanish Civil War.

1939–45 Portugal remains neutral during World War II, but lets the Allies use air bases in Azores.

1947 Attempted revolt is crushed. Labor leaders and rebel army officers are deported to Cape Verde.

1949 Portugal becomes founding member of NATO.

1961 India annexes Goa and other Indian colonies. Guerrilla warfare breaks out in Angola, Mozambique, and Guinea.

1970 Death of Salazar. Succeeded by Marcelo Caetano.

1974 Carnation Revolution: Left-wing Armed Forces Movement overthrows Caetano in bloodless revolution.

1974–75 Portuguese colonies of Guinea-Bissau, Mozambique, Cape Verde Islands, São Tomé and Príncipe, and



António Salazar

A profoundly religious and conservative man, Salazar presided over a corporatist and reactionary state that suppressed all political opposition.

Angola gain independence. Some 750,000 expatriates return to Portugal.

1975 Communist takeover foiled by Mário Soares's Socialist Party (PS). Portuguese withdraw from East Timor.

1976 General António Eanes elected president. Adoption of new constitution. Soares appointed prime minister.

1980 General Eanes reelected.

1982 Civilian government restored.

1983 Soares becomes caretaker prime minister; PS is majority party.

1985 Aníbal Cavaco Silva becomes prime minister of minority Social Democratic Party (PSD) government.

1986 Soares elected president. Portugal joins European Union.

1987 Cavaco Silva wins absolute majority in parliament.

1995 PS wins elections; António Guterres becomes prime minister.

1996 Former PS leader Jorge Sampaio elected president.

1999 Portugal returns Macao, the last European colony in Asia, to China.

2002 Portugal adopts the euro. José Manuel Barroso of the Socialist Party forms center-right coalition government.

2007 Portugal votes to legalize abortion.

2008 Portuguese parliament votes to reform spelling of the language to bring it in line with Brazilian practices.

2009 Socialists under Jose Socrates reelected with reduced minority.

2010 Protests and strikes break out against the government's austerity program.

«224–25 Voyages of Discovery
«238–39 Trade and Empire
«268–69 The Lisbon Earthquake
«280–81 The Slave Trade
«412–13 End of the Colonial Era

PORTUGUESE KING (1554–78)

SEBASTIÃO I

The tragedy of King Sebastião is one of the seminal events of Portuguese history. At the age of 24, he received permission from the pope to lead a crusade against the infidel in Morocco. Landing on the North African coast, he unwisely led his troops inland, and, on August 4, 1578, was met by a well-equipped Muslim army at the Battle of Alcazarquivir. The Portuguese force was routed, and Sebastião was never seen again. Doubts over his fate gave rise to the legend of the king who would one day return.

